

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

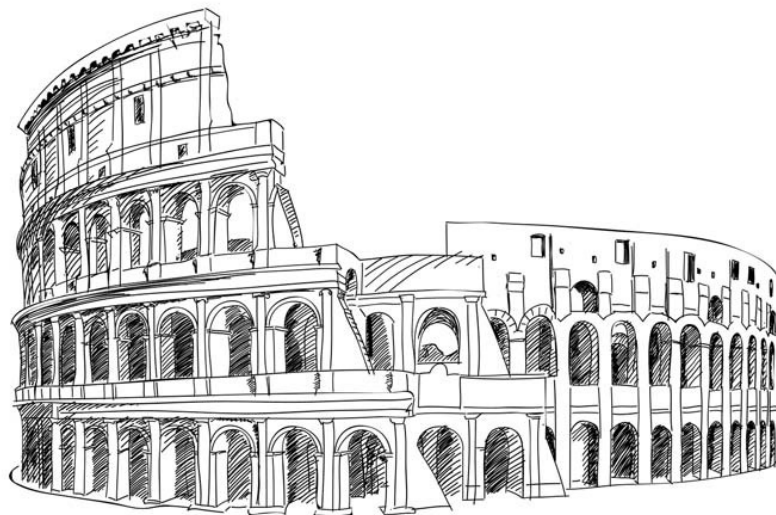
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Revisiting Ancient Wonders



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations.

Ask your partner:

- Can you name some of the Seven Wonders of the Ancient World?
- Why do you think some places are called natural wonders?

Can Do Statements

- I can write a paragraph about history and civilization.
- I can contrast two related events or actions.
- I can report facts about events or actions.



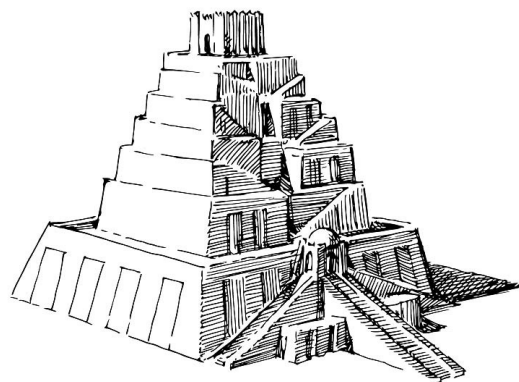


Let's Explore!

Historians and tourists **alike*** have **marveled**** at the ancient city of Babylon and the Colossus of Rhodes. Let's discover their secrets.

* "Alike" means in the same way.

** "To marvel" means to feel great surprise, wonder, or admiration.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Ah, the city of Babylon and its amazing gardens! The city, ruled by Nebuchadnezzar II, must have been quite a sight to those travelers who arrived there. Historians wrote about these "hanging" gardens, which were planted on a series of terraces supported by columns by ancient Babylonians. Some believe that the gardens were built by the king in about 600 BC in an area that is now southern Iraq.

In this period, Babylon was at the height of its power and influence. King Nebuchadnezzar is known to have ordered the construction of a vast array of buildings, including temples, and palaces to make it more beautiful. He also commissioned streets for the city and walls to surround it.

Tradition has it that the gardens were created by the king to console his wife, who missed her homeland. Although Babylon rarely received rain, the gardens were lush and provided an oasis in the desert landscape. Even though there were no modern engines or water pumps at such an early date, the gardens were constantly irrigated with the water from the Euphrates River. It must have been an astonishing sight!

Despite being one of the Seven Wonders of the Ancient World, the Colossus of Rhodes is often overlooked. The immense statue, standing almost 100 feet high, was one of the tallest erected in ancient times. Made of bronze, the statue of the sun god Helios was erected by the citizens near the harbor of their island in about 280 BC. This colossus was built as a celebration of freedom. Although the Colossus collapsed during an earthquake in 225 BC, the pieces lay untouched where they had fallen for hundreds of years. Then, in the middle of the seventh century, the metal fragments were gathered by invading Arab tribes and were carried off. Some have noted that it took as many as 900 camels to carry the pieces away. In spite of its destruction, historians and tourists alike still admire this majestic work of art.





Let's Practice!

Can you contrast two related events in the past?

Instructions: Use the Words from the Word bank to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

Despite being / In spite of / Although / Even though

1. _____ Babylon rarely received rain, the gardens were lush and provided an oasis in the desert landscape.
2. _____ it was an immense task given the lack of modern engines and pressure pumps in the fifth century BC, the gardens were constantly irrigated by using the water from the Euphrates River.
3. _____ one of the Seven Wonders of the Ancient World, the Colossus of Rhodes is often overlooked.
4. _____ its destruction, historians and tourists alike still admire this majestic work of art.



Let's Practice!

Now, it's your turn to write about history and civilizations.

Instructions: Write a 100-120 word paragraph on the Great Pyramid of Giza. Use paragraph structure (topic sentence, supporting sentences and a concluding sentence). Use a variety of sentence lengths. Use linking words like also, overall and furthermore to connect ideas. Write your paragraph on an additional sheet of paper.

My paragraph

1. Topic sentence:

2. Supporting sentences:

3. Concluding sentence:





Extension Activity

Let's delve into the past. What can you learn about ancient civilizations?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to a local library and look for information about another ancient wonder.
- Use the information from 3 different sites or books and take notes.
- Compile the information and write a 120-150 word paragraph.
- Use the Passive form to talk about facts and events.
- Proofread your paragraph.
- Read your paragraph to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research ancient civilizations.

☐ ☐

I use my notes to write a paragraph about an ancient wonder.

☐ ☐

I use the Passive form to talk about facts and events.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **terrace** (noun): a flat area next to a building where people can sit and relax
e.g. Historians wrote about these "hanging" gardens, which were planted on a series of terraces supported by columns by ancient Babylonians.
- **astonishing** (adjective): causing a feeling of great surprise or wonder
e.g. It must have been an astonishing sight!
- **array** (noun): a large group or number of things
e.g. Nebuchadnezzar is known to have ordered the construction of a vast array of buildings.
- **to console** (verb): to try to make someone feel less sadness or disappointment
e.g. Tradition has it that the gardens were created by the king to console his wife, who missed her homeland.
- **oasis** (noun): an area in a desert where there is water and plants
e.g. Although Babylon rarely received rain, the gardens were lush and provided an oasis in the desert landscape.
- **to irrigate** (verb): to supply something, such as land, with water by artificial means
e.g. Even with the absence of modern engines and water pumps at such an early date, the gardens were constantly irrigated with the water from the Euphrates River.
- **to erect** (verb): to build something by putting together materials
e.g. Made of bronze, the statue of the sun god Helios was erected by the citizens near the harbor of their island in about 280 BC





Learning Points

Adverbial Clauses of Contrast

You use **adverbial clauses** of contrast in your writing to show that the actions you are writing about are not expected.

Using clauses of this nature makes your writing more sophisticated and easier to read.

Adverbial clauses of contrast refer to a concession (where you compromise) or when the result is unanticipated or unforeseen.

The clauses are introduced by the conjunctions *although*, *even though*, *though*, *whereas*, *despite*, *in spite of* or *while*.

For example:

Although Babylon rarely received rain, the gardens were lush and provided an oasis in the desert landscape.

These types of clauses are dependent - meaning they cannot stand alone. They need to be attached to the main clause.

Examples:

- ***Even though*** there were no modern engines or water pumps at such an early date, the gardens were constantly irrigated with the water from the Euphrates River.
- ***Despite*** being one of the Seven Wonders of the Ancient World, the Colossus of Rhodes is often overlooked.
- ***In spite of*** its destruction, historians and tourists alike still admire this majestic work of art.
- ***Although*** the Colossus collapsed during an earthquake in 225 BC the pieces lay untouched where they had fallen for hundreds of years.





Learning Points

Simple Past Passive

You use the **Simple Past** to talk about finished events at a particular time in the past.
You use the **Simple Past passive** when you want to focus on the action that is done to the subject.

You form the passive by using **was/were + past participle**.

The doer or agent of the action is either not known or not mentioned as the receiver of the action is more important to the context.

For example:

*Historians wrote about these "hanging" gardens, which **were planted** on a series of terraces supported by columns.*

Sometimes you use the preposition 'by' to mention the person or thing that did the action.

For example:

*Some believe that the gardens **were built by** the king in about 600 BC in an area that is now southern Iraq.*

Examples:

- *The amazing "hanging" gardens were planted on terraces so the vegetation spilled down.*
- *They were built in a dry area, which made them even more wonderful to see.*
- *Tradition has it that the gardens were created by the king to console his wife, who missed her homeland.*

